H-Town Classic FAQs

October 17-18, 2026 • Katy, Texas

ABOUT THE H-TOWN CLASSIC

What is the H-Town Classic?

The H-Town Classic is a 3x3 youth basketball tournament celebrating competition and community in the Greater Houston area. Brought to you by Academy Sports & Outdoors and sponsored by Nike and Jordan Brand, the event brings together 128 teams across 4 divisions in a double-elimination format. All proceeds benefit the Boys & Girls Clubs of Greater Houston, making this tournament both a celebration of the game and a community investment.

Meet your tournament hosts

The H-Town Classic will be MC'd by Kiotti Brown, the voice of the Houston Rockets and Tausha Quan. Together, they will be providing live commentary and keeping the energy high throughout the tournament weekend.

What are the event dates and location?

Dates: October 17-18, 2026

Location: Academy Sports + Outdoors Flagship Store

Address: 23155 Katy Fwy, Katy, TX 77450

The tournament takes place on the front lot of the Academy flagship store, as we transform it into a basketball festival with 6 half courts running simultaneously along with games and activities.

Who is behind the tournament?

Hosted by Academy Sports + Outdoors, the tournament is also sponsored by Nike and Jordan brands

Where do the proceeds go?

All proceeds from the H-Town Classic benefit the Boys & Girls Clubs of Greater Houston, supporting youth programs and community development in the Houston area.

EVENT DETAILS

The H-Town Classic is a 32-team double-elimination tournament with 4 divisions for middle and high school boys and girls. Each team may have up to 4 players and must have a minimum of 3 players at registration.

What divisions are offered?

The H-Town Classic features 4 divisions:

- Middle School (11-14) Men's
- Middle School (11-14) Women's
- High School (14-18) Men's
- High School (14-18) Women's

How many games will my team play?

Each team plays in a 32-team double-elimination bracket. In double-elimination format, teams typically play a minimum of 2-3 games, with opportunities to advance based on wins and losses. The exact number of games depends on your team's performance in the tournament.

What time does the tournament start and end?

Games are scheduled to START at 8:30 AM on both days. On Saturday, please arrive by 8AM for check in and to pick up your jerseys.

Games are scheduled to end at 7pm on both days.

What is the schedule for Saturday and Sunday?

Games run continuously on both days from start to finish in order to finish before sunset both days. Game time and court assignments will be based on how you advance in the tournament.

Why does the tournament end at 7pm both days?

Games end at 7pm to ensure all play concludes before the sun goes down, allowing for optimal visibility and safety throughout the tournament.

REGISTRATION

How do I register my team?

Registration information will be available on the official H-Town Classic website. Visit the registration portal to complete your team entry and payment. Team registration will include all player information and division selection.

What is the team entry fee?

Team entry fee information will be posted on the official H-Town Classic website. Early registration may offer discounts compared to late registration.

Is there a registration deadline?

Yes. To guarantee your team spot and division placement, registration must be completed by the announced deadline. Late registrations may be accepted on a space-available basis. Check the official website for specific deadline dates.

Can I change players after registering?

Player change policies will be announced closer to the event date. Typically, teams may make changes before event start, subject to applicable fees. Details will be provided on the registration page.

Can my team have co-ed rosters?

Teams must register in the appropriate gender division (Men's or Women's). Consult the official H-Town Classic website for any co-ed division options if available.

Do all team members have to be from the same school?

No. You can form your team with players from different schools, as long as all players meet the age/grade requirements for your selected division.

Can a player be on multiple teams?

While individual players may be eligible to play on multiple teams, scheduling conflicts may occur. The tournament cannot guarantee game time separation for players on multiple teams, so conflicts are possible.

TOURNAMENT RULES

Key Rule: Games are to 21 points or 21 minutes long, whichever comes first.

What are the game rules for the H-Town Classic?

The H-Town Classic follows 3x3 basketball rules with the following specifications:

- Game Length: First to 21 points OR 21 minutes, whichever comes first
- Game Format: 3x3 (3 players per team on court)
- Bracket: Double-elimination format

For complete rules and regulations, consult the official H-Town Classic rulebook available on the website.

How does 3x3 basketball differ from traditional 5x5?

3x3 basketball is a faster-paced, half-court game with 3 players per side instead of 5. Key differences include:

- Played on half a court
- Smaller rosters (3-4 players per team)
- Faster pace and quicker game resolution
- Players return to the back line after scores
- 2-point line at the 3-point distance

What happens in a double-elimination bracket?

In double-elimination, teams get a second chance after their first loss. After losing once, teams move to the "losers' bracket" and continue playing. Teams are eliminated after losing twice. This format continues until a champion emerges from the winners' bracket and a runner-up from the losers' bracket.

Are there restrictions on which division players can join?

Players must be within the age/grade range for their division:

- Middle School Division: Ages 11-14 / grades 6-8
- High School Division: Ages 14-18 / grades 9-12

*If your birthday is before Sept 1, you will be assigned to the older grade you are eligible for. If your birthday is after Sept 1, you will be assigned to the lower grade you are eligible for

There may be 14-year-olds playing in either division depending on their date of birth. If your team has players from different age groups, the team will be placed in the bracket of your oldest player's age group.

What happens if a team forfeits?

Forfeit policies will be detailed in the official H-Town Classic rules and tournament guidelines. Teams should plan to have their roster available for all scheduled games to avoid forfeits.

DAY-OF LOGISTICS

Where should teams check in?

Team check-in details will be provided in your registration confirmation email and on the official H-Town Classic website. Check-in typically occurs on the morning of competition. We recommend that you arrive early to allow time for check-in, as games begin at 8:30 AM.

What time should we arrive?

Teams should arrive well before their first scheduled game to allow time for check-in and court familiarization. Since games start at 8:30 AM on Saturday, early morning arrival is recommended.

Is parking available?

There is limited parking available at the Academy Sports + Outdoors location in Katy where the tournament is being held. Additional parking information, including available lots and any parking fees, will be provided closer to the event date.

Can spectators attend?

Yes! Family, friends, and community members are welcome to attend the H-Town Classic. The event is designed as a community celebration of basketball, so spectators are encouraged. Beyond basketball, there will be shopping, food, and interactive entertainment throughout the venue.

Will there be food and beverages available?

Yes. The H-Town Classic features food vendors and shopping opportunities throughout the event. While some water will be provided, it's recommended to bring water and snacks for your team as well, given the outdoor setting and long tournament hours.

What should I bring?

Recommended items for tournament day:

- Basketball shoes and appropriate athletic wear

- Water and electrolyte beverages
- Snacks and energy foods
- Sunscreen (outdoor event)
- Hat or visor
- Towel
- ID/registration confirmation
- Any necessary medications

How will game brackets be posted?

Bracket assignments will be sent to team captains via email prior to the event. Brackets will also be posted at the venue and available on the official H-Town Classic website.

How will I know my team's game times?

Game schedules will be sent to your team contact after registration closes. Schedules are typically sent 1-2 weeks before the event. Arrive early, as schedules can change based on other game results.

What is the weather contingency plan?

Weather contingency plans will be communicated before the event. Since games must end by 7pm both days, the schedule is tight. Organizers will monitor conditions and provide updates. Check the official website and your email for any weather-related updates.

Is the event accessible for people with disabilities?

Yes. Academy Sports + Outdoors is a public facility with ADA accommodations. Please contact the H-Town Classic organizers if you have specific accessibility needs or questions.